

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

damages both our relationship with the other person and our sense of self-worth. If you're in a pattern of failing to enforce your boundaries, it can feel difficult to start following through with your requests, especially if the other person is used to benefitting from your porous boundaries. Tawwab's suggestion with most boundary challenges is to stay calm and firm, but it might be helpful for you to think about the situations where these boundary violations arise, and come up with some suitable responses that you can practise ahead of time. Calling out behaviour from those you care about can feel very confrontational, which I understand can be scary, but naming problem behaviour, such as someone testing your limits or ignoring your wishes, can really help the other person to see that they're being out of order.

After this, it's important to be consistent. Just enforcing your boundaries once or twice is not likely to be enough to see a long-lasting change in the way that you interact in your relationships, or to create that protective ring around your resources that's essential to both your financial wellbeing and your general sense of happiness and self-esteem. If you allow your boundaries to lapse, or once again become porous, it can be confusing for the other person in the relationship, and your self-worth will once again start to become worn away as your resources deplete.

If this section resonates particularly with you, I highly recommend *Set Boundaries, Find Peace* as further reading. Now, though, it's time to think about what boundaries can mean for